

and sends it to the image model. You can then iteratively tweak images by asking for variations.

Key abilities:

- Turn text prompts → images
- Edit or refine images via conversation
- Good at translating nuanced prompts into visuals

Gemini's Nano Banana / Nano Banana Pro

Google's Gemini platform has its own image models (Nano Banana, Nano Banana Pro), accessible via Gemini apps and through APIs. They let you:

- Generate images from text or mixed text+image prompts
- Edit parts of an image
- Blend multiple images
- Render high-quality text in images (for posters, logos, book covers)
- Iterate on an image in conversation until it matches your vision

Prompt basics for image generation (DALL-E + Gemini)

Based on common guidance from DALL-E prompt tutorials, you'll get better results if your prompt covers:

- **Subject** – who/what is in the image
- **Style** – illustration, watercolor, flat design, anime, photorealistic, etc.
- **Composition** – close-up, wide shot, isometric, overhead, etc.
- **Lighting** – soft light, neon, golden hour, etc.
- **Colour palette** – muted pastels, high contrast, monochrome, etc.
- **Extra details** – mood, environment, any text that should appear

Example:

"An isometric illustration of a cozy home reading corner, with a person curled up in an armchair, books stacked around them, a sleeping cat, warm ambient lighting, soft pastel colours, flat 2D style suitable for a magazine spread."

Workflow: Turn your story or blog into a visual set

Step 1 – Summarise the vibe

After you draft your story or blog, ask ChatGPT:

"Summarise the visual vibe and main motifs of this piece in 3–4 bullet points that I could use as prompts for illustrations."

Step 2 – Generate cover and spot illustrations with DALL-E/Gemini

For the cover:

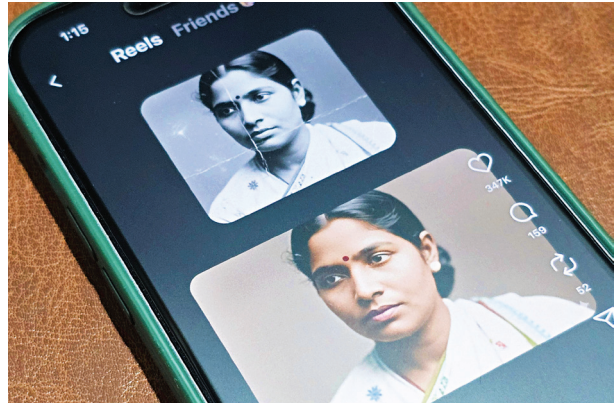
"Create a cover illustration based on these motifs: [paste].
Style: [choose one]."

Intended use: digital article cover at 16:9 ratio."

For in-article illustrations:

"Generate 3 spot illustrations representing these scenes: [list scenes]. Keep the style consistent with the cover."

Tools like Gemini's image generation APIs are explicitly designed to keep character and style consistent across images.



Step 3 – Iterate

Refine by saying:

"Make the colours slightly cooler and remove the text."

"Change the character's clothing to casual Indian streetwear."

Repeat until it feels right.

Creative practice: redraw or remix AI art

If you want to improve your own drawing skills, don't treat AI images as the end product; treat them as reference boards:

1. Generate a scene in DALL-E or Gemini.
2. Try redrawing it by hand in your own style.
3. Ask AI:

"Suggest 5 variations of this scene that would challenge me to practise different perspectives or lighting."

This makes AI your prompt engine and reference provider, not your replacement.

(Always check the usage rights for images generated by your tool and avoid using AI art to impersonate real artists' styles in a deceptive way.)

The magic isn't in asking AI to do everything for you. It's in:

- Letting it curate what you read
- Letting it compress what you don't have time to read fully
- Letting it unstick your writing and art
- Letting it package your finished work nicely

If you only do one thing after this chapter, try this:

Tonight, ask your AI assistant to design a 4-week "read + create" plan: one book, four longform pieces, and four tiny creative outputs (blog posts, sketches, or images). Then actually follow it – with AI riding shotgun, not driving the car.

That's how "I want to read and create more in 2026" becomes "Here's my fourth finished thing this year – and it's only April." **d**